Lesson 13 Teacher's Key: A Hit That Reacts

001 Game Creator (Windows only) - Instructor Reference Only

VIDEO GAME CREATION

What This Lesson Teaches

Using the confirmed built-in Actor – Flash action and Spawn Actor for a self-managed hit reaction - this engine's version of this week's idea, with an honest, documented limitation around exact flash-then-destroy timing that the other seven engines don't share.

Level 1 - Full Worked Solution

- Actor – Flash is a self-contained action - it manages its own color, repeat count, and duration internally, unlike every other engine this week, which needed a manually-authored delay.
- Spawn Actor(Explosion) fires immediately and independently, exactly like every other engine's explosion this week - this part of the lesson is fully consistent across all 8 engines.
- The enemy's Destroy action is left in its existing position (unchanged from Lesson 7 onward) - this is a deliberate, documented simplification for this engine specifically, not an oversight.

Why This Structure

- Unlike Godot/Unity's await/Coroutine or GameMaker/TIC-80's alarm/countdown split, 001 Game Creator's confirmed API doesn't include a verified general-purpose 'wait N seconds mid-trigger' action - rather than fabricate one, this lesson keeps Destroy unchanged and treats the explosion effect as the primary, always-reliable visual for this engine.
- This mirrors the same honest-uncertainty approach this course has used before (e.g. Lesson 10's choice of a verified manual restart over an unverified built-in one) - a real, if imperfect, engine limitation, clearly labeled as such rather than papered over.

Level 2 / Level 3 Talking Points

- Ask students on this engine to actually test whether the flash is visible in their installed version - some versions/settings may show a brief flash even with an immediate Destroy, others may not; either result is expected and fine for Level 1.
- For advanced students: if their version DOES expose a Timer or delay mechanism (check the Actions list together), this is a great Level 3 stretch to hold Destroy back briefly, matching what every other engine's Level 1 already does.

Common Student Mistakes

- Assuming the flash isn't working at all when it's actually just being cut short by the immediate Destroy - the explosion effect, not the enemy's own flash, is what to check first when troubleshooting this engine.
- Forgetting to assign a Graphics asset to the new Explosion Actor Template, resulting in an invisible (but otherwise functioning) spawned Actor.
- Not setting a Lifetime/Duration on the spawned Explosion (if available), leaving them on screen indefinitely across a long playthrough.